

Chain Story

Weekly Module — one class period per day, five days.

THE WEEK'S ARC

Five stories, five moods. The fold-and-pass mechanic never changes, so by Tuesday your class runs it without you — only the opening line changes each day.

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

MONDAY	Silly — “Once, at exactly midnight, the school's pet hamster opened one e...”
TUESDAY	Mystery — “The locker at the end of the hall had been sealed for twenty yea...”
WEDNESDAY	What if — “What if gravity took the day off, starting right after breakfast...”
THURSDAY	No words — “The first artist draws a character. Fold. The next draws where i...”
FRIDAY	Your genre — “Scary, funny, epic, heartbreaking — vote, then write your own op...”

ONE TIP

Keep Friday's genre vote quick: thirty seconds, majority wins, no campaigning.

This module is enrichment — a supplement to your own plans, not a curriculum. Print one sheet per group per day, and photocopy freely for your own classroom.

Chain Story

A story written by everyone — and read by no one, until the end.

GROUPS OF 3–6 · ~10 MINUTES · PENCILS ONLY · NO PREP — ONE SHEET PER GROUP

THE STORY STARTS HERE:

Once, at exactly midnight, the school's pet hamster opened one eye and said...

WRITER 1

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

WRITER 2

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

WRITER 3

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

WRITER 4

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

WRITER 5

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

WRITER 6

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

UNFOLD & READ ALOUD — every group reads its story to the class. Expect chaos.

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THE CASE STARTS HERE:

The locker at the end of the hall had been sealed for twenty years — until this morning.

WRITER 1

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 2

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 3

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 4

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 5

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 6

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

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THE QUESTION IS:

What if gravity took the day off, starting right after breakfast?

WRITER 1

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 2

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 3

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 4

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 5

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 6

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

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NO WORDS TODAY.

The first artist draws a character. Fold. The next draws where it lives. Fold. Keep building its world — pictures only.

ARTIST 1

----- draw your part, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
ARTIST 2

----- draw your part, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
ARTIST 3

----- draw your part, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
ARTIST 4

----- draw your part, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
ARTIST 5

----- draw your part, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
ARTIST 6

----- draw your part, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

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YOUR GROUP PICKS THE GENRE:

Scary, funny, epic, heartbreaking — vote, then write your own opening line below and start the chain.

WRITER 1

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 2

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 3

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 4

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 5

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----
WRITER 6

----- write your line, then fold back along this line and pass left -----

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Story Gallery

The week's best story, unfolded and preserved.

Friday's last ten minutes: every group copies its best unfolded story of the week onto this sheet, signs it, and pins it up for the class to read.

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

GROUP NAMES & AUTHORS: _____